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Sheikh Mohammed chairs the Cabinet meeting at Qasr Al Watan in Abu Dhabi yesterday that was also attended by Sheikh Mansour Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, Vice-President, Deputy Prime Minister and Chairman of the Presidential Court and Sheikh Hamdan Bin Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Crown Prince of Dubai, Deputy Prime Minister and Minister of Defence of the UAE and Chairman of Dubai Executive Council.

# 16,000 decisions mark UAE Cabinet's 20 years

CABINET REVIEWS 20 YEARS OF FEDERAL GOVERNMENT WORK

**DUBAI**  
BY KHITAM AL AMIR  
Chief News Editor

His Highness Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum, Vice-President and Prime Minister of the UAE and Ruler of Dubai, yesterday chaired a Cabinet meeting at Qasr Al Watan in Abu Dhabi, during which ministers reviewed the journey of the UAE Cabinet over the past 20 years.

In posts shared following the meeting, Sheikh Mohammed said the federal government, through more than 16,000 Cabinet decisions, thousands of task forces and budgets exceeding Dh1.1 trillion, has reshaped government work across the country.

He said these efforts focused on simplifying services, reviewing legislation, modernising technological, investment, virtual and legal infrastructure, and transitioning the country into a new phase of development driven by efficiency and future readiness.

## Model of development

Sheikh Mohammed said: "The UAE, under the leadership of President His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan, has firmly established a model of development. Through this excep-

20 years ago, we decided to strive for first place, while some doubted this ambition. Today, the UAE has become a development model that other countries seek to emulate."

Sheikh Mohammed Bin Rashid Al Maktoum

**Dh1.1tr**  
budget approved by federal government in last 20 years

tional journey, the UAE now ranks among global leaders in more than 280 development indicators, including citizen wellbeing, education, health care and housing."

He added that the UAE's progress also extends to its trade and economic relations, global standing in artificial intelligence, space industries

and sovereign assets, as well as its ability to attract top global talent. Sheikh Mohammed said the country continues to strengthen its role as a vital economic link connecting East and West.

## 20th anniversary

The Cabinet meeting coincided with the 20th anniversary of Sheikh Mohammed's accession as Ruler of Dubai, a milestone traditionally marked by forward looking initiatives and reviews of national progress rather than ceremonial celebrations.

The Vice-President said: "20 years ago, we decided to strive for first place, while some doubted this ambition. Today, the UAE has become a development model that other countries seek to emulate. This model is now being shared with more than 55 countries around the world. This journey of excellence will continue under the umbrella of the Union and in line with the directives of the leader of the Union, His Highness Sheikh Mohamed Bin Zayed Al Nahyan."

Sheikh Mohammed added: "What lies ahead will be even better. We move forward with optimism and hope, and we promise our people of glory, prosperity and a good life for the generations to come, God willing."

## Four expat siblings die in Abu Dhabi car crash

7-year-old Indian boy succumbs to injuries after three others died on Sunday

**DUBAI**  
BY SAJILA SASEENDRAN  
Chief Reporter

A seven-year-old boy, who was critically injured in a devastating car crash that killed his three brothers and the family's domestic worker, died yesterday evening, raising the death toll in Sunday's tragedy to five.

Azzaam, one of the two surviving children of Indian expats Abdul Latheef and Rukhsana, succumbed to his injuries at a hospital in Abu Dhabi, where he had been fighting for his life since the accident in the early hours of Sunday, a relative and a social worker assisting the family confirmed to *Gulf News*.

## Deadly crash

Ashaz, 14, Ammaar, 12, and Ayyash, five, along with the family's domestic worker Bushra, 39, died when their vehicle crashed in the early hours of Sunday morning as they were driving back to Dubai from the popular Liwa Festival. The parents and the other two children, Azzaam

Azzaam, one of the two surviving children of Indian expats Abdul Latheef and Rukhsana, succumbed to his injuries at a hospital in Abu Dhabi, where he had been fighting for his life since Sunday.

and Izzaa, 10, had been rushed to the hospital for treatment.

The tragic development means the Kerala family has now lost all four of their sons. Their only daughter Izzaa is currently stable and has been playing on mobile phone without realising what has happened to her brothers, the relative said.

"Abdul Latheef and Rukhsana are also out of danger. Rukhsana underwent a surgery for her injured hand while still unaware that her three sons were gone. The family was finding it hard to break the news to her. Around 6.30pm, the hospital confirmed the passing of her only son who remained."

The relative added that the extended family members were working on arranging the funeral of the brothers in Dubai while the mortal remains of Bushra would be repatriated to Kerala.

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